

SUBTITLEBOOM

User Guide

Version 1.0 — First Public Release

Offline subtitle alignment, transcription, translation and editing for video and audio.

1. Getting started

1. Select the video or audio file.
2. For alignment, select the matching TXT or subtitle file. For transcription, no text input is required.
3. Choose the spoken language and Whisper model.
4. Choose the output SRT and start the requested operation.
5. Review results in the editor and save the corrected SRT.

SubtitleBoom v1.0 is the first public release under this name and is based on the Subtitle Aligner v4.1.1 development line. Existing projects remain compatible.

2. Project organization

Keep media, source text and final subtitles together. Internal data remains in SubtitleAligner_Data beside the project.

Folder	Purpose
Cache	Whisper words and timestamps for fast reopening.
Project	Complete editor state, detected speech, status and manual changes.
Reports	Review and performance reports.
Segments	Completed chunks of long Whisper jobs.

3. Main workflows

Alignment

Alignment matches existing text or subtitles to speech. Tiny is fast and recommended for this task. Smart Cache makes later openings much faster.

Transcription

Video or audio can be converted directly to SRT and plain TXT. Optional timed TXT is available. Words are kept whole, Whisper punctuation is preserved, and cues target no more than two lines of approximately 44 characters each.

Translation

Whisper's built-in Translate task creates English SRT and TXT from supported spoken languages. Translation to another target language requires a separate translation model or service.

4. Responsive editor

- Media preview at the top, with the active subtitle near the bottom.
- Waveform directly below the player.
- Timing, detected speech, text, status and primary commands remain accessible.
- The subtitle table and lower-right editor panel scroll independently.
- Changes are saved automatically and support Undo/Redo.

5. Waveform editing

Visual	Meaning / action
Gray block	Previous or next cue; click or drag to select and edit.
Blue block	Selected cue; drag center to move it.
Blue edges	Drag to change cue start or end.
Green block	Detected speech.
Red line	Current playback position.

Snap attaches nearby edges to detected speech. Hold Shift while dragging to bypass snap. Overlap protection prevents crossing neighboring cues by default; when disabled, overlaps are highlighted and confirmed with a warning.

6. Text and structural tools

- WRAP LINES: up to two balanced lines of 44 characters.
- SPLIT: divide at the text cursor.
- SMART SPLIT: choose a natural punctuation or balance point.
- MERGE WITH NEXT: join adjacent cues after checking gap, length and reading speed.
- ADD ROW ABOVE/BELOW and DELETE ROW: modify subtitle structure with automatic renumbering.
- AUTO FIX: adjust timing alignment without replacing the split/merge tools.

7. Status and tolerance

Status	Meaning
RELIABLE / STRONG	Good match; normally requires no correction.
CHECK / MODERATE	Listen and verify.
WEAK	Manual review is recommended.
NOT FOUND	Speech was not reliably located; shown in bold red.

Custom tolerance recalculates status from start/end deviation and confidence without running Whisper or moving cues. Hover over a status for numeric details.

8. Editing progress and backups

Manually changed rows retain a pencil marker and light sky-blue background, while the selected row remains dark blue. The last selected cue is restored on reopening. Every Save As copy receives independent project state, so backup SRT files preserve their own progress.

9. Batch Mode

6. Place each media file and matching TXT in the same project folder.
7. Add a parent folder; SubtitleBoom searches subfolders recursively.
8. Correct any automatic pairing by selecting the proper TXT cell.
9. Choose language and model independently for every row.
10. Start the queue; jobs run sequentially for stability.

Batch Mode never moves, deletes or modifies originals. The aligned SRT remains beside the media and supporting data remains in SubtitleAligner_Data.

10. Languages and models

Automatic detection is first and all other spoken languages are alphabetized. Interface and processing language are independent. Serbian Latin and Serbian Cyrillic are separate choices; alignment compares scripts internally without changing source text. Croatian remains Latin-only.

Model	Recommended use
Tiny — fast	Alignment and quick processing.
Base — standard	Balanced speed and accuracy.
Small and larger	Demanding transcription and translation; slower processing.

11. Supported formats

Direction	Formats
Import	TXT, SRT, VTT, SBV, ASS/SSA, TTML/DFXP
Export	SRT, VTT, SBV, ASS, TXT
YouTube package	SRT + VTT + SBV

Advanced ASS/SSA styling may be simplified when converted to formats that do not support it. Keep the original styled file as a backup.

12. Keyboard shortcuts

Shortcut	Function
Space	Play/Pause
Esc	Stop
F1	Help
F2	Project overview
F3 / Shift+F3	Next / previous problem
Alt+Left / Alt+Right	Previous / next cue
Ctrl+Enter	Apply
Ctrl+S	Save
Ctrl+Z / Ctrl+Y	Undo / Redo
Delete	Delete selected cue

13. Project overview and troubleshooting

F2 displays project health, cue counts, confidence statistics, edited rows, save state, processing performance and important file paths. Health is an advisory estimate; always review the final SRT.

- Speech not found: listen around the cue and use Detect Speech or adjust timing manually.
- Cache missing: the original SRT remains intact; SubtitleBoom rebuilds supporting data when needed.
- Long media: completed segments are retained so interrupted processing can continue.
- Small display: scroll the lower-right panel with its scrollbar or mouse wheel.

14. Portable use and privacy

After BUILD.bat creates PROGRAM, copy the entire PROGRAM folder—not only SubtitleBoom.exe. Whisper, FFmpeg, models, languages, documentation and configuration are stored with it. Some interface settings remain in the Windows user profile, while project progress remains beside working files in SubtitleAligner_Data.

Processing is local. Original media and text are not uploaded by SubtitleBoom. Optional support uses only the PayPal.Me address configured in PROGRAM\config\donation.txt.